4. **Safety and Security:** Greater safety is another feature of this method of filing. Papers do not get torn or gather dust since they are well- protected by manilafolders kept safety in drawers, which can also be locked to provide security to confidential documents.

5. **Universal Application:** Vertical filing has proved useful in preserving all types of papers, documents and memorandum. Orders, invoices, letters, quotations, tenders, government circulars, etc., can be filed with great ease and preserved without difficulty.

6. **Adaptability:** Vertical filing can be easily adapted to all types of classification. The folders can be arranged alphabetically, numerically, geographically, subject-wise or on some other basis according to the needs of an individual office.

5.4.4. Classification of Files:

There are five methods of classification. They are:

1. Alphabetical Classification
2. Numerical Classification
3. Geographical Classification
4. Subject Classification and
5. Chronological Classification.

1. Alphabetical Classification: Alphabetical classification is based on the occurrence of the letters in the alphabet as it is done for the dictionary.

Telephone directory is another example. If several names occur having the first letter, the arrangement takes into account the subsequent letters also, for example:

A, AB, AC ---------- etc

B, Bb, BC ---------- etc.

Under the alphabetical classification, the filing of papers and documents is either by the names of the correspondents or the subjects. In a large office, it would be proper if 26 letters of the English alphabet are divided into small equal parts considering the letters which are bound to have more names. This method of classification can be used in correspondence filing, contracts, orders and staff records.



Fig. 5.6. Alphabetical Classification

2. Numerical Classification:

In this method of classification, each folder or record is given a number, and the files are placed in strict numerical order. For example Mr. Gnanasekar Ltd, may be assigned No 25. If they deal in a number of lines, each line may be classified with a number beginning with 25, for example, 25.1, 25.2, 25.3, etc.,

The system of numerical classification is generally recommended for filing of orders, sales, invoices, contracts, (where numbered) and committee minutes.

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